# SHOWING OFF INDIA

**The ministry is striving to showcase India's rich culture and tourism to its own people and the world, while trying to bring the Northeast closer to the Centre**

By Kaushik Deka

## DoNER

**EVER SINCE NARENDRA MODI** took charge as prime minister, the eight North-eastern states have emerged as the new growth engine of India and the ministry of Development of North Eastern Region (DoNER) has played a pivotal role in this. In the last eight years, the gross budgetary support through 55 ministries and departments for the development of the region has seen an increase of 185 per cent. Thanks to meticulous tracking of expenditure by the DoNER ministry under G. Kishan Reddy, the actual expenditure not only increased in the financial year gone by but also exceeded the target for the first time ever.

The launch of the Prime Minister's Development Initiative for Northeast Region (PM-DevINE) scheme in 2022 to build infrastructure projects with an outlay of Rs 6,600 crore has only speeded up the development of the region. Earlier tagged as 'remote', connectivity in the region has accelerated—over 4,000 km of road projects are being implemented, eight new airports operationalised, 19 new waterways identified and all broad-gauge lines have been electrified. From India's first sports university in Manipur to the Northeast's first AIIMS in Guwahati, the region has showcased inclusive development. The microfinance offered by North Eastern Development Finance Corporation Limited (NEDFi) has helped more than 1.6 million persons get skilled and some 900,000 to access MSMEs benefits. A regional action plan is being drawn up for the development of tourism in consultation with the north-eastern states and other stakeholders. A task force has been constituted to steer the growth of agriculture too. ■

**G. Kishan Reddy**
*Minister of Development of N-E Region, Culture & Tourism*



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### BOLD & BRAVE

110% INCREASE

**₹5,892 CRORE**
Allocation to the ministry in Budget 2023, up from ₹2,800 crore last time

**PM-DevINE scheme**
- Launched in 2022
- 4000+ km road projects implemented
- 8 new airports operationalised

### BUT...

**<₹21,000 CRORE**
Amount central ministries left unspent on the Northeast since 2018-19